

The Lady, or the Tiger?

Frank R. Stockton · 1882

First published: The Century, Nov 1882

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/The_lady,_or_the_tiger?_and_other_stories/The_Lady,_or_the_Tiger? (revision 5766637), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 9–12 (accessible text, well suited to the scaffolded-support track; scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). The scaffolded-support track works from the full text with scaffolds. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 2 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does The Lady, or the Tiger? suggest about jealousy and love?
- What does The Lady, or the Tiger? suggest about justice and chance?
- What does The Lady, or the Tiger? suggest about choice?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the story in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the story quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* The Lady, or the Tiger?	2 × 90 min (180 min)	*jealousy and love* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to The Lady, or the Tiger?

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about Frank R. Stockton's life or times connects to jealousy and love in “The Lady, or the Tiger?”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (jealousy and love, justice and chance, choice).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2

Author biography

Frank R. Stockton was born in Philadelphia on 5 April 1834. He worked as a wood engraver before turning to writing, and became assistant editor of St. Nicholas, the leading American children's magazine. He wrote fairy tales and comic stories, and his puzzle story "The Lady, or the Tiger?" (1882) made him famous; readers wrote to him for decades asking for the answer, which he never gave. He died on 20 April 1902.

Historical and cultural context

Stockton wrote for a popular magazine audience in the 1880s who loved puzzles and parlour debates. The "semi-barbaric" kingdom is a fanciful, vaguely ancient setting, not a real place.

Publication and reception, then and now

First published in The Century Magazine in November 1882.

Then: A sensation; readers flooded Stockton with letters demanding the answer, and he never gave one. It was discussed in debating clubs.

Now: A classic for teaching open endings and argument from evidence.

Overview (spoiler-free)

A semi-barbaric king tries accused men in an arena: behind one door is a lady to marry, behind the other a tiger. When a young man loves the princess, he is sent to the arena; she knows which door is which.

Main themes

- love versus jealousy.
- justice and chance.
- human nature.

Why it matters

It teaches students to make and defend a claim when the text does not give an answer.

Spoilers · teacher only

She signals him to the right-hand door, and the story ends without saying what came out.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Before we open The Lady, or the Tiger?: Would you rather see someone you love marry someone else, or die?
Prompt: Before we open The Lady, or the Tiger?: Would you rather see someone you love marry someone else, or die?

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
open ending; ambiguity; irony; characterization.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).
About the author. Frank R. Stockton was born in Philadelphia on 5 April 1834. He worked as a wood engraver before turning to writing, and became assistant editor of St. Nicholas, the leading American children's magazine. He wrote fairy tales and comic stories, and his puzzle story "The Lady, or the Tiger?" (1882) made him famous; readers wrote to him for decades asking for the answer, which he never gave. He died on 20 April 1902. The world of the book. Stockton wrote for a popular magazine audience in the 1880s who loved puzzles and parlour debates. The "semi-barbaric" kingdom is a fanciful, vaguely ancient setting, not a real place. Publication and reception. First published in The Century Magazine in November 1882. Then: A sensation; readers flooded Stockton with letters demanding the answer, and he never gave one. It was discussed in debating clubs. Now: A classic for teaching open endings and argument from evidence.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Which came out of the opened door,—the lady, or the tiger" slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator asks which came out of the door: the lady or the tiger. Next, craft. I notice it is an unanswered question, so the ending is handed to the reader. The strongest word is "tiger": the plain, dangerous animal stands against "the lady," so the choice is death or a rival's marriage. Then, effect. Why does the story end on this question? My answer: Stockton refuses to tell us, so we must decide what the princess's jealousy and love would do; the reader becomes the judge.

> *Which came out of the opened door,—the lady, or the tiger* *(The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 26)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Which came out of the opened door,—the lady, or the tiger" slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator asks which came out of the door: the lady or the tiger. Next, craft. I notice it is an unanswered question, so the ending is handed to the reader. The strongest word is "tiger": the plain, dangerous animal stands against "the lady," so the choice is death or a rival's marriage. Then, effect. Why does the story end on this question? My answer: Stockton refuses to tell us, so we must decide what the princess's jealousy and love would do; the reader becomes the judge.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): A semi-barbaric king tries accused men in an arena: behind one door is a lady to marry, behind the other a tiger. When a young man loves the princess, he is sent to the arena; she knows which door is which. Themes to track: love versus jealousy.: justice and chance.: human nature.:

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Page: justice and chance. Prediction: the semi-barbaric king's arena will put a lover's fate in the hands of a choice between two doors. Question: what will the princess's jealousy and love lead her to do?
Task: Set up a reading journal for The Lady, or the Tiger?: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Page: justice and chance. Prediction: the semi-barbaric king's arena will put a lover's fate in the hands of a choice between two doors. Question: what will the princess's jealousy and love lead her to do?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does The Lady, or the Tiger? still matter? It teaches students to make and defend a claim when the text does not give an answer.
Anchor question: Why might The Lady, or the Tiger? still be taught today?
Facilitation: It teaches students to make and defend a claim when the text does not give an answer.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
Stockton first read this story aloud at a party in 1882 before printing it in The Century magazine that November, and readers wrote to Stockton demanding the answer. Why might a writer choose not to give one? Answer: Accept answers such as: to make readers of The Century argue about human nature; the unsolved puzzle made Stockton famous; he wanted each reader to decide what the princess chose.
Exit ticket: Stockton first read this story aloud at a party in 1882 before printing it in The Century magazine that November, and readers wrote to Stockton demanding the answer. Why might a writer choose not to give one?
Answer: Accept answers such as: to make readers of The Century argue about human nature; the unsolved puzzle made Stockton famous; he wanted each reader to decide what the princess chose.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: The Lady, or the Tiger?.

Teacher notes · sources: Britannica, "Frank R. Stockton" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Frank-R-Stockton); Frank R. Stockton, The Lady, or the Tiger? and Other Stories (1884) (https://www.gutenberg.org/)

Lesson 2: The Lady, or the Tiger?

Focus: a choice the reader must make

Objective: Students will analyze how structure develops in "The Lady, or the Tiger?" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (implied violent death): Sensitive content: Implied violent death. Preview the story, tell students in advance, and allow a pass on reading aloud. Keep discussion on how the writer uses these elements, not on graphic detail.
Student preview: Heads-up: this story includes implied violent death.
Suggested language: "Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

A semi-barbaric king judges the accused in an arena: the accused opens one of two doors, behind one a tiger, behind the other a lady he must marry. When the princess's lowborn lover is caught, she learns which door hides which. She signals him to the right-hand door. The story ends without telling us what came out.

Background: Published in The Century in 1882 and widely debated; Stockton reportedly never answered.

Significance: The most famous open ending in American fiction; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Would you rather someone you love be happy with someone else, or lose them forever? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to love versus jealousy because.... Content note before we start: Heads-up: this story includes implied violent death.
Prompt: Would you rather someone you love be happy with someone else, or lose them forever?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to love versus jealousy because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: her choice is the story.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: exuberant — joyously unrestrained; gnashed — grind together, of teeth; fateful — decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end; rewarded — given something good in return; premises — (in the old legal phrase "in the premises") the matter just described.
Words: exuberant: joyously unrestrained · gnashed: grind together, of teeth · fateful: decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end · rewarded: given something good in return · premises: (in the old legal phrase "in the premises") the matter just described

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Published in The Century in 1882 and widely debated; Stockton reportedly never answered. The most famous open ending in American fiction; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans. Ambiguity: The ending is unresolved by design. Irony: The "impartial" arena is a matter of chance, not justice. Characterization: The princess is "semi-barbaric" like her father, passionate and jealous. Watch for the doors: fate and choice.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "semi-barbaric king" slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator introduces the king as only half civilized. Next, craft. I notice the joking tone: the narrator treats the king's cruelty almost playfully. The strongest word is "semi-barbaric": the "semi" makes him a mix of civilized and savage, which is the mixture the story tests. Then, effect. What does "semi-barbaric" tell us about the king? My answer: "Semi-barbaric" tells us the king is half civilized and half savage: his justice looks orderly but is really cruel chance, and the word prepares us for an arena where fate decides everything.

> *semi-barbaric king (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 1)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "semi-barbaric king" slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator introduces the king as only half civilized. Next, craft. I notice the joking tone: the narrator treats the king's cruelty almost playfully. The strongest word is "semi-barbaric": the "semi" makes him a mix of civilized and savage, which is the mixture the story tests. Then, effect. What does "semi-barbaric" tell us about the king? My answer: "Semi-barbaric" tells us the king is half civilized and half savage: his justice looks orderly but is really cruel chance, and the word prepares us for an arena where fate decides everything.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Students should say what "slight, quick" suggests: a decision already made. Ask: How does this line connect to love versus jealousy? Expected: Her choice is the story. (Her signal.)

> *She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Students should say what "slight, quick" suggests: a decision already made.
Ask: How does this line connect to love versus jealousy?
Expected answer: Her choice is the story. (Her signal.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the story for ambiguity, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about a choice the reader must make? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Lady, or the Tiger? develops the idea of a choice the reader must make. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. When the text says “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17), it shows this directly. She shares her father's "semi-barbaric" nature and has thought jealously about the lady, yet she loves the man; when she makes "a slight, quick movement toward the right," the reader must decide which side of her won.

Task: Annotate the story for ambiguity, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about a choice the reader must make? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Lady, or the Tiger? develops the idea of a choice the reader must make. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. When the text says “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17), it shows this directly. She shares her father's "semi-barbaric" nature and has thought jealously about the lady, yet she loves the man; when she makes "a slight, quick movement toward the right," the reader must decide which side of her won.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Would you rather someone you love be happy with someone else, or lose them forever? Debate: lady or tiger.

Anchor question: Would you rather someone you love be happy with someone else, or lose them forever?

Facilitation: Debate: lady or tiger.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Story quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Story quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about a choice the reader must make? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. ("She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right", The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about a choice the reader must make? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. ("She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right", The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how ambiguity shapes a choice the reader must make. Key takeaway: her choice is the story.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Ambiguity:** The ending is unresolved by design.
- **Irony:** The "impartial" arena is a matter of chance, not justice.
- **Characterization:** The princess is "semi-barbaric" like her father, passionate and jealous.

Themes and how they develop

- **love versus jealousy:** her choice is the story.

Symbols and motifs

- **the doors:** fate and choice.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "semi-barbaric king" (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 1) Setting.
- "She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right" (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17) Her signal.
- "Which came out of the opened door,—the lady, or the tiger" (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 26) The question.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings.
Evidence: “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17)
Reasoning: She shares her father's "semi-barbaric" nature and has thought jealously about the lady, yet she loves the man; when she makes "a slight, quick movement toward the right," the reader must decide which side of her won.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
exuberant (adjective)	joyously unrestrained	*He was a man of exuberant fancy, and, withal, of an authority so irresistible that, at his will, he turned his varied fancies into facts.*	
gnashed (verb)	grind together, of teeth	*How in her grievous reveries had she gnashed her teeth, and torn her hair, when she saw his start of rapturous delight as he opened the door of the lady!*	
fateful (adjective)	decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end	*The king and his court were in their places, opposite the twin doors,—those fateful portals, so terrible in their similarity.*	
rewarded (verb)	given something good in return	*This vast amphitheatre, with its encircling galleries, its mysterious vaults, and its unseen passages, was an agent of poetic justice, in which crime was punished, or virtue rewarded, by the decrees of an impartial and incorruptible chance.*	
premises (noun)	(in the old legal phrase “in the premises”) the matter just described	*He did not hesitate nor waver in regard to his duty in the premises.*	
depended (verb)	be contingent upon (something that is elided)	*Think of it, fair reader, not as if the decision of the question depended upon yourself, but upon that hot-blooded, semi-barbaric princess, her soul at a white heat beneath the combined fires of despair and jealousy.*	
hesitate (verb)	pause or hold back in uncertainty or unwillingness	*He did not hesitate nor waver in regard to his duty in the premises.*	

Discussion questions

1. Would you rather someone you love be happy with someone else, or lose them forever?
2. Where does structure appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with jealousy and love?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16,

17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. How does the king's arena decide guilt? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The accused opens one of two doors
2. What is behind the two doors? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A tiger and a lady
3. Why is the princess's lover on trial? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He loved the king's daughter
4. Which door does the princess point to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The right-hand door
5. How does the story end? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: It asks the reader which came out
6. Retell the three most important events of “The Lady, or the Tiger?” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A semi-barbaric king judges the accused in an arena: the accused opens one of two doors, behind one a tiger, behind the other a lady he must marry. When the princess's lowborn lover is caught, she learns which door hides which. She signals him to the right-hand door. The story ends without telling us what came out.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “The Lady, or the Tiger?”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “The Lady, or the Tiger?” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: “He was a man of exuberant fancy, and, withal, of an authority so irresistible that, at his will, he turned his varied fancies into facts.” What does “exuberant” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: exuberant: joyously unrestrained.
10. Reread: “How in her grievous reveries had she gnashed her teeth, and torn her hair, when she saw his start of rapturous delight as he opened the door of the lady!” What does “gnashed” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: gnashed: grind together, of teeth.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “The Lady, or the Tiger?” suggest about a choice the reader must make? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The most famous open ending in American fiction; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans.
2. Find one example of structure in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the story is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
3. How does the irony in this story shape what we understand about a choice the reader must make? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say

and what is true.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “semi-barbaric king” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 1): Setting. On irony: The "impartial" arena is a matter of chance, not justice. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. In the passage that begins “But even here the exuberant and barbaric fancy asserted itself.”, why might Stockton have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “The Lady, or the Tiger?”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A semi-barbaric king judges the accused in an arena: the accused opens one of two doors, behind one a tiger, behind the other a lady he must marry. When the princess's lowborn lover is caught, she learns which door hides which. She signals him to the right-hand door. The story ends without telling…
6. As the opening story, what does “The Lady, or the Tiger?” set up that the rest of The Lady, or the Tiger? will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17): Her signal. Theme link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “Which came out of the opened door,—the lady, or the tiger” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 26): The question. On characterization: The princess is "semi-barbaric" like her father, passionate and jealous. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Would you rather someone you love be happy with someone else, or lose them forever?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with jealousy and love? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “semi-barbaric king” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 1): Setting. On characterization: The princess is "semi-barbaric" like her father, passionate and jealous. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Published in The Century in 1882 and widely debated; Stockton reportedly never answered. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s ·

RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17): Her signal. Theme link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The most famous open ending in American fiction; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “Which came out of the opened door,—the lady, or the tiger” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 26): The question. Theme link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “semi-barbaric king” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 1): Setting. On characterization: The princess is "semi-barbaric" like her father, passionate and jealous. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “The Lady, or the Tiger?” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about a choice the reader must make? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17): Her signal. Theme link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “The Lady, or the Tiger?”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “Which came out of the opened door,—the lady, or the tiger” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 26): The question. Theme link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this story to justice and chance: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Stockton need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “semi-barbaric king” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 1): Setting. Theme

link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the structure in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17): Her signal. Theme link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “The Lady, or the Tiger?” treats a choice the reader must make with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Lady, or the Tiger? see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “Which came out of the opened door,—the lady, or the tiger” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 26): The question. Theme link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. As the final story, does this ending resolve jealousy and love? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “semi-barbaric king” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 1): Setting. Theme link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a choice the reader must make? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17): Her signal. Theme link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Frank R. Stockton about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Useful evidence: “Which came out of the opened door,—the lady, or the tiger” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 26): The question. Theme link: her choice is the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Structure:** look for how the story is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why is the princess's lover on trial?
   A. He loved the king's daughter
   B. He insulted the king
   C. He killed a guard
   D. He stole from the king

   Key: A (He loved the king's daughter)
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17: “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick _____ toward the right”

   Key: movement
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does the king's arena decide guilt?
   A. The king decides
   B. The accused opens one of two doors
   C. A jury votes
   D. A duel

   Key: B (The accused opens one of two doors)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does the story end?
   A. The lover marries the lady
   B. The tiger kills him
   C. It asks the reader which came out
   D. The princess frees him

   Key: C (It asks the reader which came out)
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 26: “Which came out of the _____ door,—the lady, or the tiger”

   Key: opened
6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He did not hesitate nor waver in regard to his duty in the _____.” Word bank: premises, exuberant, gnashed, fateful

   Key: premises
7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Think of it, fair reader, not as if the decision of the question _____ upon yourself, but upon that hot-blooded, semi-barbaric princess, her soul at a white heat beneath the combined fires of despair and jealousy.” Word bank: exuberant, fateful, gnashed, depended

   Key: depended
8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which door does the princess point to?
   A. The left-hand door
   B. Both
   C. Neither
   D. The right-hand door

Key: D (The right-hand door)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is behind the two doors?

   A. A prison and freedom

   B. Gold and a sword

   C. A tiger and a lady

   D. Two tigers

   Key: C (A tiger and a lady)

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He did not _____ nor waver in regard to his duty in the premises.” Word bank: fateful, hesitate, exuberant, gnashed

    Key: hesitate

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “semi-barbaric king” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Setting.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “The Lady, or the Tiger?”?

    A. A choice the reader must make

    B. Guilt that the mind cannot hide

    C. Accepting one's place in nature's cycle

    D. A wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home

    Key: A (A choice the reader must make)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Her signal.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “The Lady, or the Tiger?”? The ending is unresolved by design.

    A. Symbolism

    B. Characterization

    C. Ambiguity

    D. Structure

    Key: C (Ambiguity)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “The Lady, or the Tiger?”? The "impartial" arena is a matter of chance, not justice.

    A. Personification

    B. Alliteration

    C. Foreshadowing

    D. Irony

    Key: D (Irony)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the story: “Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: She shares her father's "semi-barbaric" nature and has thought jealously about the lady, yet she loves the man; when she makes "a slight, quick movement toward the right," the reader must decide which side of her won.

17. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17).
    Sample answer: She shares her father's "semi-barbaric" nature and has thought jealously about the lady, yet she loves the man; when she makes "a slight, quick movement toward the right," the reader must decide which side of her won.
18. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Which came out of the opened door,—the lady, or the tiger” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 26). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The question.
19. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how love versus jealousy develops from an earlier story to “The Lady, or the Tiger?”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: her choice is the story.
20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “semi-barbaric king” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Setting.
21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Her signal.
22. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The king and his court were in their places, opposite the twin doors,—those fateful portals, so terrible in their similarity.”, what does “fateful” most nearly mean?

    A. grind together, of teeth
    B. given something good in return
    C. decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end
    D. joyously unrestrained

    Key: C (decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end)
23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “This vast amphitheatre, with its encircling galleries, its mysterious vaults, and its unseen passages, was an agent of poetic justice, in which crime was punished, or virtue rewarded, by the decrees of an impartial and…”, what does “rewarded” most nearly mean?

    A. given something good in return
    B. grind together, of teeth
    C. decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end
    D. joyously unrestrained

    Key: A (given something good in return)
24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “How in her grievous reveries had she gnashed her teeth, and torn her hair, when she saw his start of rapturous delight as he opened the door of the lady!”, what does “gnashed” most nearly mean?

    A. given something good in return
    B. joyously unrestrained
    C. decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end

D. grind together, of teeth

Key: D (grind together, of teeth)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	9, 2, 3, 10, 6, 4, 7, 5, 8, 12, 13, 11, 15, 17, 18, 19	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	2, 5, 10, 9, 3, 4, 6, 1, 13, 12, 11, 18, 14, 15, 20, 21	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	5, 9, 4, 6, 8, 1, 2, 12, 13, 11, 18, 17, 15, 14, 21, 19	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	9, 5, 10, 8, 6, 3, 12, 11, 13, 14, 18, 15, 17, 20, 19, 16	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	3, 22, 10, 5, 4, 11, 13, 12, 17, 18, 15, 14, 19, 20, 16, 21	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	23, 1, 7, 10, 4, 11, 13, 12, 14, 17, 18, 15, 19, 21, 20, 16	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	5, 2, 4, 6, 10, 12, 11, 13, 17, 18, 15, 14, 20, 16, 19, 21	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	6, 7, 23, 24, 4, 12, 11, 13, 14, 15, 17, 18, 19, 16, 21, 20	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	6, 3, 8, 7, 23, 11, 13, 12, 15, 14, 18, 17, 16, 20, 19, 21	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	9, 5, 8, 23, 10, 12, 11, 13, 17, 14, 15, 18, 16, 21, 19, 20	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Lady, or the Tiger?,” how does Stockton show a choice the reader must make? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the structure you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In The Lady, or the Tiger?, how does Stockton develop the idea of a choice the reader must make? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the structure in the story helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how The Lady, or the Tiger? develops the idea of a choice the reader must make. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of The Lady, or the Tiger? (where it begins, turns and ends) and its structure shape the reader's understanding of a choice the reader must make. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what The Lady, or the Tiger? suggests about a choice the reader must make. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's structure and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Frank R. Stockton uses structure in The Lady, or the Tiger? to complicate the reader's understanding of a choice the reader must make. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate The Lady, or the Tiger? within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of a choice the reader must make responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read The Lady, or the Tiger? alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of a choice the reader must make follows or bends those conventions, using the structure as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Lady, or the Tiger? and its treatment of a choice the reader must make. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's structure and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads The Lady, or the Tiger? as evidence for a larger claim about a choice the reader must make in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads The Lady, or the Tiger? as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of a choice the reader must make. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Lady, or the Tiger?.

SAT-style questions

1. *The king and his court were in their places, opposite the twin doors,—those fateful portals, so terrible in their similarity.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “fateful” most nearly mean?

   A. pause or hold back in uncertainty or unwillingness

   B. be contingent upon (something that is elided)

   C. decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end

   D. (in the old legal phrase “in the premises”) the matter just described

2. *But even here the exuberant and barbaric fancy asserted itself. The arena of the king was built, not to give the people an opportunity of hearing the rhapsodies of dying gladiators, nor to enable them to view the inevitable conclusion of a conflict between religious opinions and hungry jaws, but for purposes far better adapted to widen and develop the mental energies of the people. This vast amphitheatre, with its encircling galleries, its*

mysterious vaults, and its unseen passages, was an agent of poetic justice, in which crime was punished, or virtue rewarded, by the decrees of an impartial and incorruptible chance.

Which choice best states a central concern of "The Lady, or the Tiger?"?

A. The futile attempt to shut out death

B. Hope created by an act of sacrifice

C. A choice the reader must make

D. Greed that grasps more than a person needs

SAT key: 1. C (decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end); 2. C (A choice the reader must make)

Unit test

The Lady, or the Tiger?: end test · 90 minutes · 18 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why is the princess's lover on trial?
   A. He loved the king's daughter
   B. He insulted the king
   C. He killed a guard
   D. He stole from the king

   Key: A (He loved the king's daughter)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is behind the two doors?
   A. A prison and freedom
   B. Gold and a sword
   C. A tiger and a lady
   D. Two tigers

   Key: C (A tiger and a lady)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does the king's arena decide guilt?
   A. The king decides
   B. The accused opens one of two doors
   C. A jury votes
   D. A duel

   Key: B (The accused opens one of two doors)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 26: “Which came out of the _____ door,—the lady, or the tiger”

   Key: opened
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does the story end?
   A. The lover marries the lady
   B. The tiger kills him
   C. It asks the reader which came out
   D. The princess frees him

Key: C (It asks the reader which came out)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17: “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick _____ toward the right”

   Key: movement

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He did not hesitate nor waver in regard to his duty in the _____.” Word bank: premises, exuberant, gnashed, fateful

   Key: premises

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which door does the princess point to?

   A. The left-hand door

   B. Both

   C. Neither

   D. The right-hand door

   Key: D (The right-hand door)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Think of it, fair reader, not as if the decision of the question _____ upon yourself, but upon that hot-blooded, semi-barbaric princess, her soul at a white heat beneath the combined fires of despair and jealousy.” Word bank: exuberant, fateful, gnashed, depended

   Key: depended

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He did not _____ nor waver in regard to his duty in the premises.” Word bank: fateful, hesitate, exuberant, gnashed

    Key: hesitate

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “The Lady, or the Tiger?”?

    A. A choice the reader must make

    B. Guilt that the mind cannot hide

    C. Accepting one's place in nature's cycle

    D. A wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home

    Key: A (A choice the reader must make)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Her signal.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “semi-barbaric king” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Setting.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “The Lady, or the Tiger?”? The "impartial" arena is a matter of chance, not justice.

    A. Personification

    B. Alliteration

    C. Foreshadowing

    D. Irony

    Key: D (Irony)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “The Lady, or the Tiger?”? The ending is unresolved by design.

    A. Symbolism

    B. Characterization

    C. Ambiguity

    D. Structure

    Key: C (Ambiguity)

16. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17).

    Sample answer: She shares her father's "semi-barbaric" nature and has thought jealously about the lady, yet she loves the man; when she makes "a slight, quick movement toward the right," the reader must decide which side of her won.

17. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Which came out of the opened door,—the lady, or the tiger” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 26). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The question.

18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “She raised her hand, and made a slight, quick movement toward the right” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 17) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Her signal.

19. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “semi-barbaric king” (The Lady, or the Tiger?, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Setting.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the story: “Stockton's description of the princess gives evidence for both endings.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: She shares her father's "semi-barbaric" nature and has thought jealously about the lady, yet she loves the man; when she makes "a slight, quick movement toward the right," the reader must decide which side of her won.

21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how love versus jealousy develops from an earlier story to “The Lady, or the Tiger?”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: her choice is the story.

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The king and his court were in their places, opposite the twin doors,—those fateful portals, so terrible in their similarity.”, what does “fateful” most nearly mean?

    A. grind together, of teeth

    B. given something good in return

    C. decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end

    D. joyously unrestrained

    Key: C (decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “He was a man of exuberant fancy, and, withal, of an authority so irresistible that, at his will, he turned his varied fancies into facts.”, what does “exuberant” most nearly mean?

    A. joyously unrestrained

    B. given something good in return

C. grind together, of teeth

D. decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end

Key: A (joyously unrestrained)

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “This vast amphitheatre, with its encircling galleries, its mysterious vaults, and its unseen passages, was an agent of poetic justice, in which crime was punished, or virtue rewarded, by the decrees of an impartial and…”, what does “rewarded” most nearly mean?

A. given something good in return

B. grind together, of teeth

C. decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end

D. joyously unrestrained

Key: A (given something good in return)

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “How in her grievous reveries had she gnashed her teeth, and torn her hair, when she saw his start of rapturous delight as he opened the door of the lady!”, what does “gnashed” most nearly mean?

A. given something good in return

B. joyously unrestrained

C. decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end

D. grind together, of teeth

Key: D (grind together, of teeth)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	4, 9, 3, 2, 5, 1, 7, 8, 10, 6, 12, 13, 11, 16, 17, 15, 14, 19	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	4, 10, 6, 7, 8, 5, 9, 2, 3, 1, 12, 13, 11, 16, 15, 14, 20, 19	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	4, 8, 9, 6, 1, 10, 2, 7, 3, 12, 11, 13, 14, 17, 15, 16, 19, 21	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	9, 2, 7, 6, 4, 10, 3, 5, 13, 11, 12, 16, 14, 17, 15, 19, 20, 21	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	4, 8, 22, 2, 3, 23, 7, 13, 12, 11, 15, 14, 16, 17, 18, 21, 19, 20	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	1, 24, 25, 3, 4, 7, 8, 11, 12, 13, 15, 17, 16, 14, 18, 20, 21, 19	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	8, 4, 24, 9, 25, 22, 1, 12, 13, 11, 16, 17, 15, 14, 19, 20, 18, 21	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	24, 2, 3, 10, 8, 23, 6, 12, 11, 13, 16, 14, 17, 15, 18, 20, 19, 21	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior		

	24, 25, 7, 3, 10, 1, 23, 11, 12, 13, 17, 14, 15, 16, 21, 18, 20, 19	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	1, 22, 9, 24, 2, 10, 25, 12, 11, 13, 14, 17, 15, 16, 18, 19, 21, 20	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Final paper

The Lady, or the Tiger?: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Frank R. Stockton develops jealousy and love across The Lady, or the Tiger?. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in The Lady, or the Tiger? and argue how its meaning changes over the story and why that change matters to justice and chance.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Argue whether the story judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether The Lady, or the Tiger? finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of choice. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 4 quotations from at least two parts of the story. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.
Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.

Essay assignments

Essay: Jealousy and love

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Lady, or the Tiger? teaches about jealousy and love. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Frank R. Stockton develops jealousy and love in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Frank R. Stockton develops jealousy and love across The Lady, or the Tiger?. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Lady, or the Tiger? (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of jealousy and love. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of jealousy and love in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Frank R. Stockton's choices in The Lady, or the Tiger? (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of jealousy and love, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Lady, or the Tiger?'s treatment of jealousy and love in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on jealousy and love in The Lady, or the Tiger? that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on jealousy and love in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about jealousy and love in The Lady, or the Tiger?, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on jealousy and love in The Lady, or the Tiger?, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Justice and chance

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Lady, or the Tiger? teaches about justice and chance. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Frank R. Stockton develops justice and chance in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Frank R. Stockton develops justice and chance across The Lady, or the Tiger?. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Lady, or the Tiger? (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of justice and chance. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of justice and chance in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Frank R. Stockton's choices in The Lady, or the Tiger? (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of justice and chance, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Lady, or the Tiger?'s treatment of justice and chance in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

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Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Choice

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Lady, or the Tiger? teaches about choice. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Frank R. Stockton develops choice in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Frank R. Stockton develops choice across The Lady, or the Tiger?. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Lady, or the Tiger? (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of choice. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of choice in The Lady, or the Tiger?. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Frank R. Stockton's choices in The Lady, or the Tiger? (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of choice, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Lady, or the Tiger?'s treatment of choice in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

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College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about choice in The Lady, or the Tiger?, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

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Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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